

New Grad Job Search Tracker & Salary Negotiation Kit

Everything a new graduate needs to run a real job search: offer comparison, application tracker, and negotiation scripts.

Educational use only.
This product contains educational information and templates. Nothing here is professional, legal, tax, or investment advice. For decisions that matter, talk to a qualified professional.

01. Offer Comparison Calculator — Worked Example

Enter multiple offers side by side. The calculator adjusts for cost-of-living differences so you can compare apples to apples.

Cost-of-living indices: 100 = your current city, NYC ~190, SF ~220, rural Midwest ~70. Find indices at [meric.org](#) or [numbeo.com](#)

Component	Offer A (NYC)	Offer B (Austin)
Base Salary	\$95,000	\$85,000
Signing Bonus	\$15,000	\$5,000
Annual Bonus	15%	10%
Equity Value	\$12,000	\$8,000
Benefits Value	\$8,000	\$7,000
COL Index	190	120

Total Comp (Year 1):
Offer A: \$95,000 + \$15,000 + \$14,250 + \$12,000 + \$8,000 = \$144,250
Offer B: \$85,000 + \$5,000 + \$8,500 + \$8,000 + \$7,000 = \$113,500
COL-Adjusted (normalized to your COL index of 100):
Offer A: \$144,250 × (100/190) = \$75,921 (purchasing power)
Offer B: \$113,500 × (100/120) = \$94,583 (purchasing power)
Result: Offer B has 24% more purchasing power

02. Salary Negotiation Scripts — 6 Common Pushback L

- 1. ""This is our standard offer for your level."**
Your response: "Thank you. I'm excited about the role. Based on my research, experience, and the market there room to move on base salary, equity, or signing bonus?"

2. ""We can't go higher; our equity budget is locked."
Your response: "I understand. Since we're constrained on equity, can we revisit base salary or a higher sig

3. ""We offer great benefits. The value is really Y."
Your response: "I appreciate that. My number assumes I'm already accounting for healthcare. What I'm as salary / signing bonus."

4. ""We'd prefer to not negotiate; we're fair to everyone."
Your response: "I believe you are. I'm not asking for unfair treatment. I've done my research, and I think the rate."

5. ""If we do this, we have to do it for everyone."
Your response: "I understand that matters for morale. My ask is based on my background and skills. I'm op you."

6. ""You can always revisit this in 6 months."
Your response: "I appreciate that. Salary adjustments on a typical schedule are rare. I'd like to land on a n

03. Application Tracker Template

Track every application so you don't lose track of follow-ups or interview dates

Date	Company	Role	Stage	Follow-up
9/1	Acme Corp	Software Engineer	Applied	9/8
9/3	BuildCo	Product Manager	Phone screen	9/10
9/5	TechStart	Data Analyst	Take-home test	9/12

04. Interview Prep Checklist by Round

Recruiter Phone Screen

- Research the company and role (15 min)
- Prepare 2–3 examples of past projects/impact
- Practice answering: "Tell me about yourself" (30 sec pitch)
- Know 2–3 genuine questions to ask them

Technical Panel

- Review core skills / fundamentals for the role
- Practice explaining past work without jargon
- Have a whiteboard / coding environment ready
- Ask clarifying questions before diving into solutions

Final Round / Leadership

- Prepare a 1–2 min summary of why you're interested
 - Prepare 1–2 questions about company strategy / culture
 - Research the person(s) you're meeting (LinkedIn, company site)
 - Prepare a follow-up email template
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